

QUESTION TAG

What is a Question Tag ?

A question tag is a statement followed by a small question. We use question tags to ask for confirmation. In a question tag a statement is made and a question is asked after that.

Examples :-

- You are busy, **Aren't you ?**
- Pinnacle is the best institute for preparing for government jobs, **isn't it ?**

Four basic rules have to be kept in mind while making question tags:

1. The sentence and the question tag will be in the same tense.
2. If the **sentence is positive**, the **question tag will be negative**. If the **sentence is negative**, the **question tag will be positive**.
3. The **pronoun** is always used in the question tag.
4. In **negative question tags** we use the contracted form of the **'helping verb and not'**. Eg- Hasn't, couldn't etc.

Rules & Explanations along with Application/Examples:

1. In a positive sentence the question tag will be negative.

Examples :-

- A good student always works hard, **doesn't he ?**
- A teacher goes to school daily, **doesn't he ?**
- Madhu plucks flowers, **doesn't she ?**
- You appeared at the SSC examination, **didn't you ?**
- Helmet makes driving safe, **doesn't it ?**

2. In a negative sentence the question tag will be positive.

Examples :-

- All the children were not present, **were they ?**
- Everybody cannot be clever, **can they ?**

3. For sentences having **Modal Auxiliary (can, could, will, would, may, might, must, shall, should, ought to, need, would rather, had better, dare)**, tags will be shan't, won't, can't etc depending on whether **positive or negative** is needed.

Original form	Contracted form	Original form	Contracted form	Original form	Contracted form
Are not	Aren't	Do not	Don't	Might not	Mighn't
Can not/cannot	Can't	Does not	Doesn't	Must not	Mustn't
Could not	Couldn't	Have not	Haven't	Need not	Needn't
Dare not	Daren't	Had not	Hadn't	Ought not	Oughtn't
Did not	Didn't	Is not	Isn't	Shall not	Shan't
Does not	Doesn't	May not	Mayn't	Should not	Shouldn't
Was not	Wasn't	Will not	Won't		
Were not	Weren't	Would not	Wouldn't		

Examples :-

- A healthy body can achieve the impossible, **can't it ?**
- A student should be regular in studies, **shouldn't he ?**
- Everybody cannot drive, **can they ?**
- Everybody should wear a seat belt while driving, **shouldn't they ?**

4. **Everybody, everyone, no one, nobody, none etc.** are **singular**. So we use a **singular verb** and **singular pronoun** with them. But in the question tag a **plural verb** and a **plural pronoun** will be used.

Examples :-

- Everybody has to pay his own bill, **haven't they ?**

- None of your friends has arrived yet, **have they ?**

5. For Positive Imperative sentences we use “won’t you” in the question tag.

Examples :-

- Go to the market, **won’t you ?**
- Please give me the documents, **won’t you ?**
- Kindly take a seat, **won’t you ?**

6. When we ask somebody to do some work or when we offer something, then we use “will you/would you” in the question tag.

Examples :-

- Be assured of all co-operation, **will you ?**
- Have some rest, **would you ?**
- Switch on the cooler, **will you ?**

7. For Negative Imperative sentences we use “will you” as the question tag.

Examples :-

- Don’t touch the wire, **will you ?**
- Don’t litter here, **will you ?**
- Don’t make a noise in class, **will you ?**

8. For Imperative sentences beginning with “let us”, When a suggestion or proposal is being made, the question tag will be “shall we”.

Examples :-

- Let us go for a movie, **shall we ?**
- Let us help her to complete the work, **shall we ?**
- Let us go to meet her, **shall we ?**

9. For Imperative sentences beginning with “let” but not followed by “us”, the question tag will be “will you”.

Examples :-

- Let Madhu go, **will you ?**
- Let them do their homework, **will you ?**
- Let the labourer go, **will you ?**

10. For imperative sentences having nothing, anything, everything, something as the subject the question tag will have “it” as the pronoun.

Examples :-

- Everything has gone bad today, **hasn’t it ?**
- Everything is clear, **isn’t it ?**
- Nothing can revive this worse situation, **can it ?**

11. If any sentence has “used to” in it then the question tag will be “usedn’t/didn’t”.

Examples :-

- He used to come here, **usedn’t he ?**
- He used to play the casio very well, **didn’t he ?**

12. Never, no, nobody, hardly, seldom, scarcely, few, little, not, none, rarely etc. are negative words. So the question tag will not be negative.

Examples :-

- A barking dog seldom bites, **does it ?**
- My son never stands still, **does he ?**
- He hardly does his duties, **does he ?**

13. In exclamatory sentences the question tag will contain the auxiliary verbs.

Examples :-

- How beautiful the garden is, **isn’t it ?**
- How big the slide is, **isn’t it ?**

- How nicely the bird sings, **isn't it ?**

14. Moon, earth, river, motherland, country, ship, train are treated as **feminine gender**. In the question tag the pronoun used will be **"she"**. Instead of **"she"**, **"it"** can also be used.

Examples :-

- The Titanic was thought to be unsinkable, **wasn't she ?**
- India has never attacked any country, **has she ?**

15. There is no contracted form of **"am not"**. So in question tags, **"aren't"** is used.

Examples :-

- I am a little late today, **aren't I ?**
- I am confident, **aren't I ?**

Note :- But if the sentence used is **negative**, then in question tag **"am I"** can be used.

Examples :-

- I am not late today, **Am I ?**
- I am not busy, **Am I ?**

16. If the subject of a sentence is **there /one /this /that /these /those**, then the question tag will contain **there /one /this** etc as the **pronoun**.

Examples :-

- There is a book on the table, **isn't there ?**
- One cannot find a solution to this problem, **can one ?**

17. Collective nouns are used in **singular form** so the **question tag** will have a **singular verb** and a **singular pronoun**.

Examples :-

- The class has selected its monitor, **hasn't it ?**
- The team has played very well, **hasn't it ?**

Note :- But if the **collective noun** is not treated as one unit, we use the **plural verb and the plural pronoun**.

Examples :-

- The team have to arrange for their own shoes, **haven't they ?**

Practice Exercise

Give The Correct Question Tag For The Following

- Q.1.** Cricket is more popular today, _____?
- Q.2.** Every action has an opposite reaction, ____?
- Q.3.** I am a student of Pinnacle, _____?
- Q.4.** I had a bad headache yesterday, _____?
- Q.5.** It is an important matter, _____?
- Q.6.** I am happy, _____?
- Q.7.** The jury gave different opinions, _____?
- Q.8.** The kid is crying, _____?
- Q.9.** It was a terrible accident, _____?
- Q.10.** We must eat vegetables, _____?
- Q.11.** Love the poor, _____?

- Q.12. I am taking tea, _____?
- Q.13. We should love our country, _____?
- Q.14. Everything was alright, _____?
- Q.15. We were warned of the danger, _____?
- Q.16. I am innocent, _____?
- Q.17. Neither of them were responsible, _____?
- Q.18. Man is mortal, _____?
- Q.19. I am tired, _____?
- Q.20. Either you or your brother came here, _____?
- Q.21. He cast his magic spell in the laboratory, _____?
- Q.22. Nobody cheated in the exam, _____?
- Q.23. Ice touches cold, _____?
- Q.24. Nobody dared to do it, _____?
- Q.25. It is an important matter, _____?
- Q.26. Nobody believes you, _____?
- Q.27. Somebody will say so, _____?
- Q.28. It hardly rains during the dry season, _____?
- Q.29. There are many mistakes in it, _____?
- Q.30. It is easy to say, _____?
- Q.31. There are some problems here, _____?
- Q.32. There is a little water in the pot, _____?
- Q.33. It is quite a big garden, _____?
- Q.34. There are six seasons in India, _____?
- Q.35. There has been an accident, _____?
- Q.36. She needs to buy a pen, _____?
- Q.37. Nobody believes a liar, _____?
- Q.38. One of the legs has been broken, _____?
- Q.39. She has been fasting, _____?
- Q.40. The poor are born to suffer, _____?
- Q.41. Someone went there, _____?
- Q.42. Sultan thanked the Quazi, _____?

- Q.43. Nobody called me, _____?
- Q.44. We had better discuss something else, _____?
- Q.45. Hasan earned very little money, _____?
- Q.46. The baby is innocent, _____?
- Q.47. To err is human, _____?
- Q.48. Nobody came, _____?
- Q.49. The baby is playing, _____?
- Q.50. It was a good tiffin, _____?
- Q.51. Grandmother can tell good stories, _____?
- Q.52. Nothing is impossible in this world, _____?
- Q.53. The book is rare now, _____?
- Q.54. The fishermen catch fishes, _____?
- Q.55. She is happy, _____?
- Q.56. She does not like bad films, _____?
- Q.57. She has never visited the Taj Mahal, _____?
- Q.58. You are not my friend, _____?
- Q.59. He sat by me, _____?
- Q.60. Kindly do me a favour, _____?
- Q.61. Let a sleeping dog sleep, _____?
- Q.62. We are your well wishers, _____?
- Q.63. She is pretty, _____?
- Q.64. Tareq came from Gazipur, _____?
- Q.65. Nothing can satisfy him, _____?
- Q.66. Hasan put the book on his reading table, _____?
- Q.67. You need not depend on others, _____?
- Q.68. Blind men cannot see anything, _____?
- Q.69. We should respect our teachers, _____?
- Q.70. You dare not drive at night, _____?
- Q.71. You must do it, _____?
- Q.72. Blind men can't read, _____?
- Q.73. Don't boil rice, _____?
- Q.74. Get out, _____?

- Q.75. Give me a glass of water, _____?
- Q.76. How nicely she writes, _____?
- Q.77. Let us go out for a walk, _____?
- Q.78. My friends hardly come here, _____?
- Q.79. Nothing can concern you, _____?
- Q.80. He has a few friends, _____?
- Q.81. Don't bother him, _____?
- Q.82. He has little idea about it, _____?
- Q.83. Nothing can help you now, _____?
- Q.84. Close the window, _____?
- Q.85. How sweetly the bird sings, _____?
- Q.86. Do sit down, _____?
- Q.87. There is little water in the jar, _____?
- Q.88. Don't be late, _____?
- Q.89. My friends and I hardly go there, _____?
- Q.90. My friends know you, _____?
- Q.91. Let us have a cup of tea, _____?
- Q.92. He hardly realizes it, _____?
- Q.93. Come and see me again, _____?
- Q.94. He hardly studies, _____?
- Q.95. Grandmother can tell good stories, _____?
- Q.96. Her mother couldn't walk, _____?
- Q.97. Laila knows you, _____?
- Q.98. Let us go home, _____?
- Q.99. Pinnacle conducts classes in the morning, _____?
- Q.100. Let her come in, _____
- Q.101. You're going to the conference next week, _____?
- Q.102. He didn't expect to receive such positive feedback on his presentation, _____?
- Q.103. They've been working on the project for hours without a break, _____?
- Q.104. We should consider all possible solutions to the problem, _____?
- Q.105. You won't have any trouble finding your way back, _____?
- Q.106. She won't be able to attend the event due to a prior commitment, _____?

- Q.107. It's not easy to find reliable information on the internet these days, _____?
- Q.108. It's important to maintain a healthy work-life balance, _____?
- Q.109. He shall finish the project by Friday, _____?
- Q.110. Let me know if you need any help, _____?
- Q.111. Please turn off the lights, _____?
- Q.112. No one can solve this problem, _____?
- Q.113. Have some more tea, _____?
- Q.114. So you don't like my new hair style _____?
- Q.115. The presentation was informative, _____?
- Q.116. He couldn't find his keys this morning, _____?
- Q.117. She speaks five languages fluently, _____?
- Q.118. She must be feeling confident after hours of preparation, _____?
- Q.119. The flowers in the garden were blooming beautifully, _____?
- Q.120. Due to Covid-19, prices may continue to fluctuate in the coming months, _____?
- Q.121. One should always mind one's own business, _____?
- Q.122. They dare to speak up for what they believe in, _____?
- Q.123. He scarcely finishes his assignments on time, _____?
- Q.124. They dare not enter the haunted house at night, _____?
- Q.125. some employees might be feeling uncertain about their job security, _____?
- Q.126. They had booked their tickets for the Bali trip, _____?
- Q.127. My father need not worry about the expenses of my wedding, _____?
- Q.128. The team wouldn't practice in the rain, _____?
- Q.129. Mind your work, _____?
- Q.130. Let me know when you're ready, _____?

Fill in the Blanks with the Correct Question Tag

- Q.1. It'll rain soon, _____?
(a) won't it (b) bought it (c) isn't it (d) may it
- Q.2. They needn't worry, _____?
(a) isn't it (b) doesn't it (c) don't it (d) need they
- Q.3. None of the food was wasted, _____?
(a) wasn't (b) was it (c) weren't (d) were it
- Q.4. The hotel was not too expensive, _____?
(a) was it? (b) wasn't it? (c) is it? (d) isn't it?

- Q.5.** Your father used to be the principal of this college, _____?
 (a) did he? (b) does he? (c) didn't he? (d) doesn't he?
- Q.6.** I am very happy today, _____?
 (a) aren't I (b) are I (c) am I (d) are not I
- Q.7.** They fought bravely for the freedom of the country, _____?
 (a) did not they (b) don't they (c) didn't they (d) does he
- Q.8.** The mob has killed the thief, _____?
 (a) haven't it (b) hasn't it (c) has it (d) isn't it
- Q.9.** Somebody has paid the bill for you, _____?
 (a) haven't they (b) is it (c) have they (d) had they
- Q.10.** I didn't go for the classes yesterday, _____?
 (a) didn't I (b) did I (c) do I (d) isn't it
- Q.11.** They're planning to travel to Asia next summer, _____?
 (a) aren't they (b) aren't it (c) weren't they (d) should they
- Q.12.** He couldn't attend the meeting last week, _____?
 (a) can he (b) could he (c) couldn't he (d) could it
- Q.13.** We should finalize the budget by tomorrow, _____?
 (a) shouldn't us (b) shall we (c) shouldn't we (d) wouldn't we
- Q.14.** The concert was rescheduled to next month, _____?
 (a) weren't it (b) was it (c) isn't it (d) wasn't it
- Q.15.** She won't forget to bring the presentation slides, _____?
 (a) would she (b) will she (c) will it (d) might she
- Q.16.** It's important to double-check the details before submitting the application, _____?
 (a) is it (b) wasn't it (c) isn't it (d) don't you
- Q.17.** She doesn't usually stay up late, _____?
 (a) she does (b) don't she (c) doesn't she (d) does she
- Q.18.** They won't be able to attend the party due to prior commitments, _____?
 (a) will they (b) would they (c) won't they (d) will them
- Q.19.** He's not feeling well today because of the cold weather, _____?
 (a) was he (b) is it (c) is he (d) isn't it
- Q.20.** It's necessary to review the terms and conditions before signing the contract, _____?
 (a) is it (b) isn't it (c) was it (d) isn't they

Answers with Explanations:-

1	Isn't it ?	11	Won't you ?	21	Didn't he ?	31	Aren't there ?
2	Hasn't it ?	12	Aren't I ?	22	Did they ?	32	Isn't there ?
3	Aren't I ?	13	Shouldn't we ?	23	Doesn't it ?	33	Isn't it ?
4	Hadn't I ?	14	Wasn't it ?	24	Did they ?	34	Aren't there ?
5	Isn't it ?	15	Weren't we ?	25	Isn't it ?	35	Hasn't there ?
6	Aren't I ?	16	Aren't I ?	26	Do they ?	36	Doesn't she ?
7	Didn't they ?	17	Were they ?	27	Won't they ?	37	Do they ?
8	Isn't it/he ?	18	Isn't he ?	28	Does it ?	38	Hasn't one ?
9	Wasn't it ?	19	Aren't I ?	29	Aren't there ?	39	Hasn't she ?
10	Mustn't we ?	20	Didn't you ?	30	Isn't it ?	40	Aren't they ?

41	Didn't they ?	64	Didn't he ?	87	Is there ?	110	won't you
42	Didn't he ?	65	Can it ?	88	Will you ?	111	will you
43	Did they ?	66	Didn't he ?	89	Do we ?	112	can they
44	Hadn't we ?	67	Need you ?	90	Don't they ?	113	would you
45	Didn't he ?	68	Can they ?	91	Shall we ?	114	Do you
46	Isn't it ?	69	Shouldn't we ?	92	Does he ?	115	wasn't it
47	Isn't it ?	70	Dare you ?	93	Will you ?	116	could he
48	Did they ?	71	Mustn't you ?	94	Does he ?	117	doesn't she
49	Isn't it ?	72	Can they ?	95	Can't she ?	118	mustn't he
50	Wasn't it ?	73	Will you ?	96	Could she ?	119	weren't they
51	Can't she ?	74	Won't you ?	97	Doesn't she ?	120	mayn't they
52	Is it ?	75	Will you ?	98	Shall we ?	121	shouldn't one
53	Is it ?	76	Doesn't she ?	99	Doesn't it ?	122	don't they
54	Don't they ?	77	Shall we ?	100	Will you ?	123	does he
55	Isn't she ?	78	Do they ?	101	aren't you	124	dare they
56	Does she ?	79	Can it ?	102	did he	125	mightn't they
57	Has she ?	80	Hasn't he ?	103	haven't they	126	Hadn't they
58	Are you ?	81	Will you ?	104	shouldn't we	127	need he
59	Didn't he ?	82	Has he ?	105	will you	128	would they
60	Will you ?	83	Can it ?	106	will she	129	can't you
61	Will you ?	84	Will you ?	107	is it	130	will you
62	Aren't we ?	85	Doesn't it ?	108	isn't it		
63	Isn't she ?	86	Will you ?	109	Shall we		

Fill in the blanks with the Correct Question Tag :-

Sol.1.(a) Same modal has to be used so all other options get eliminated.

Sol.2.(d) Same modal has to be used so all other options get eliminated.

Sol.3.(b) The statement has "none" so the question tag will be in the positive so option (a) and (c) get eliminated.
Food is an uncountable noun so a singular verb will be used.

Sol.4.(a) The statement has "not", so the question tag will be in the positive so option (b) and (d) get eliminated.
Tense will be the same so (a) is the correct option.

Sol.5.(c) didn't he?

Sol.6.(a) aren't I

Sol.7.(c) didn't they

Sol.8.(b) Mob has been treated as singular, so the verb used will be singular.

Sol.9.(a) haven't they

Sol.10.(b) did I

Sol.11.(a) aren't they

Sol.12.(b) could he

Sol.13.(c) shouldn't we

Sol.14.(d) wasn't it

Sol.15.(b) will she

Sol.16.(c) isn't it

Sol.17.(d) does she

Sol.18.(a) will they

Sol.19.(c) is he

Sol.20.(b) isn't it

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